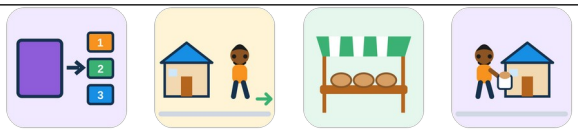
02 · Lesson spec

Break It Small · 40 minutes · whole class, then groups of 4–6 · fully unplugged

Goal	**I can break a job into small steps.**
Core parts	Move + Code
Key words	big job · small steps · break · part · shop
Materials	Shop step cards and FIRST–NEXT–LAST strips (Printables); a box shop with paper bread; a mat to roll; a plastic jug, a bowl and large card counters; cardboard Ayo



1. Watch (5 min)

- **Say:** “Ayo must go to the shop to buy bread. That is a **big job**! Before we act, we **plan**.”
- Hold up a big box, then three small boxes: “A big job is made of **small steps**. Let’s **break it small**.”
- **Ask:** “What does Ayo do first?” Take answers in children’s own words. Agree: leave home → buy bread → go home.
- **Hand signs:** big job = arms wide · small steps = tiny steps on the spot · break = snap a stick · part = hold up one finger · shop = hand out to pay.

2. Do in groups (25 min)

a) Plan, then act the shop trip (10 min) · Core: Code + Move

- **Plan first:** a child says the small steps in their own words. **Only then** does the group choose the 3 step cards and lay them on the FIRST–NEXT–LAST strip.
- **Act the plan:** leave home (cross the road safely **with a grown-up**), buy bread at the box shop, go home.
- **Stretch:** add “pay” as a 4th step (leave home → buy bread → pay → go home).

b) Practical life corner (10 min)

- Groups choose a job: **roll a mat** (flat → roll it → rolled up) or **pour counters** from a jug into a bowl (jug with counters → pour slowly → counters in the bowl).
- Say the small steps first, lay the step cards, then do the job. Count the counters in and out.

c) Activity Book page (5 min)

- Order the small steps; match step to picture. Not marked.

3. Share (10 min)

- **Create:** draw the small steps of a job you do (e.g. washing your plate: scrape, wash, dry).
- Optional Build: set up a box shop with paper bread on the grid.
- **Close:** “A big job is easier when we break it small!”

Common mistakes

- Grabbing the cards before saying the steps → “Plan first: tell me the steps. Then choose the cards.”
- Giving only the big job (“go to the shop”) → “What is the very first small step?”

- Steps in the wrong order (go home first) → “Can Ayo go home before he leaves? Check the order.”

What if it doesn’t work?

- No mat → fold a towel or a piece of cloth. No jug → a plastic cup and a box.
- Children cannot say the steps → act it once together, then say the steps.

Support and stretch

- **Support:** start with 2 steps (leave home → go home), then add the middle one.
- **Stretch** (optional, never assessed): break a bigger job into 4 steps.

How we check

Observation only. Tick each child who **says the small steps of “Ayo goes to the shop” before choosing the cards, then orders them**.

> **Safety**
> Counters bigger than a toilet-roll opening; count in and out. Plastic jug and bowl. In the acting, always cross the road with a grown-up.